

C206

Ethical Leadership

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

The manager of a paper mill in Maine, which has operated since 1920, must decide whether to close one production line. Closing it will cut 60 jobs but keep the mill solvent and protect about 400 other jobs. He closes the line, reasoning that this choice produces the best overall result for the most people. Which ethical framework is he using?

- A. Utilitarianism.
- B. Ethical egoism.
- C. Deontology.
- D. Virtue ethics.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager is using utilitarian reasoning. Which question is she asking?

- A. Could I want everyone in my position to follow this rule?
- B. Which option produces the greatest total benefit for everyone affected?
- C. Is it legal, since legal choices are always ethical?
- D. What would a person of good character do?

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A sales director at a publicly traded software firm could win a \$2 million contract by telling a client that a feature ships next week, though she knows it will not ship for three months. The deal would also save her team's bonuses. She refuses, saying lying to a client is wrong in itself, whatever the outcome. Which framework does her reasoning reflect?

- A. Virtue ethics, because honesty is a virtue.
- B. Utilitarianism.
- C. Ethical egoism, because her bonus is at stake.
- D. Deontology.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager asks, “Could I want every manager in my position to act this way?” Which framework is he applying?

- A.** Virtue ethics.
- B.** Deontology.
- C.** Utilitarianism.
- D.** Ethical relativism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A five-year-old fintech company that has made three acquisitions wants to build its ethics program on virtue ethics. Its board meets quarterly and its compliance budget is fixed for the year. Which program fits that approach best?

- A.** Leaders model honesty and courage, mentor staff, and recognize people for acting with integrity.
- B.** Hire only people who already have perfect character.
- C.** A detailed rulebook with a penalty for each violation.
- D.** A cost-benefit scorecard for every major decision.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A 90-person engineering firm gave every employee the same \$3,000 year-end bonus. Employees agree the amounts were fair, but they are upset that the bonus rules were decided in secret, with no explanation and no way to ask questions. The firm had its best revenue year ever. What kind of justice concern is this?

- A.** Interactional justice only.
- B.** Procedural justice.
- C.** Distributive justice.
- D.** No justice issue, because everyone got the same amount.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A staff accountant at a regional bank, who passed the CPA exam on her first try, is asked by her manager to backdate invoices. She refuses, explaining that the law and professional rules require accurate records and society depends on people following them. At which Kohlberg level is her reasoning?

- A. Postconventional, because refusing was the right thing to do.
- B. Postconventional, since professionals always reason at the highest level.
- C. Conventional.
- D. Preconventional.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which reason for refusing to falsify a safety report reflects Kohlberg's postconventional level?

- A. "Company policy and the law forbid it."
- B. "Being honest will help me get promoted."
- C. "I would be fired if I got caught."
- D. "I would refuse even if the law allowed it, because it violates the basic right of workers to be safe."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

At an investor conference, the CEO of a chemical company with plants in six countries says the firm's only social responsibility is to increase profits while staying within the law and fair competition. The company's stock rose 12% last year. Which view is the CEO expressing?

- A. The shareholder (Friedman) view.
- B. Carroll's CSR pyramid.
- C. Stakeholder theory.
- D. The triple bottom line.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager using stakeholder theory is weighing whether to close a plant. What does she do?

- A.** Consider shareholders' returns only.
- B.** Close only if every stakeholder group agrees, since all must always consent.
- C.** Weigh the effects on employees, the community, suppliers and customers along with shareholders.
- D.** Consider only the most powerful group.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A hospital administrator in a rural county must cut costs. She can either lay off a loyal 25-year employee or close a small outpatient clinic that serves elderly patients. The hospital recently installed new imaging equipment. What kind of ethical situation is this?

- A.** A moral temptation (right versus wrong).
- B.** Not an ethical issue, just a budget decision.
- C.** A right-versus-right dilemma.
- D.** A legal compliance issue.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A procurement manager at a 20-year-old family-friendly manufacturer is reviewing three bids for a packaging contract. One bidder is owned by her brother-in-law. His bid is the lowest and his quality ratings are the best. What should she do?

- A.** Award the contract, since his bid is objectively the best.
- B.** Make the decision herself, then disclose the relationship afterward.
- C.** Reject his bid automatically, since relatives can never be vendors.
- D.** Disclose the relationship and step away from the decision.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

The manager of a paper mill in Maine, which has operated since 1920, must decide whether to close one production line. Closing it will cut 60 jobs but keep the mill solvent and protect about 400 other jobs. He closes the line, reasoning that this choice produces the best overall result for the most people. Which ethical framework is he using?

Target word: framework behind the reasoning **Decides:** He compares total outcomes and picks the larger net good.

A	Correct	Weighing consequences for all affected and maximizing the net benefit is utilitarian.
B	Confusion set	Egoism looks at the decision-maker's own interest, not everyone's.
C	Inverted operation	Deontology judges acts by duty regardless of outcomes; he reasoned from outcomes.
D	Adjacent category	Virtue ethics centers on character, not a tally of results.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A manager is using utilitarian reasoning. Which question is she asking?

Target word: the utilitarian question **Decides:** Utilitarianism = greatest net good.

A	Confusion set	That is Kant's universalizability test.
B	Correct	That is the utilitarian test.
C	Absolute language	Law sets a floor; legal and ethical are not the same.
D	Adjacent category	That is virtue ethics.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A sales director at a publicly traded software firm could win a \$2 million contract by telling a client that a feature ships next week, though she knows it will not ship for three months. ~~The deal would also save her team's bonuses.~~ She refuses, saying lying to a client is wrong in itself, whatever the outcome. Which framework does her reasoning reflect?

Target word: framework **Decides:** She judges the act itself as wrong regardless of results.

A	Adjacent category	Her stated reason is a rule about the act, not her character.
B	Inverted operation	She explicitly sets consequences aside.
C	Camouflage	Answers the bonus detail; she acted against her own interest.
D	Correct	Holding that an act is wrong in itself, whatever the consequences, is duty-based ethics.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A manager asks, "Could I want every manager in my position to act this way?" Which framework is he applying?

Target word: framework from the question **Decides:** Universalizability is Kant's categorical imperative.

A	Adjacent category	Virtue ethics asks about character.
B	Correct	The universal-law test is the core of Kantian duty ethics.
C	Inverted operation	Utilitarianism asks about total consequences, not universal rules.
D	Confusion set	Relativism says right depends on culture; it rejects universal rules.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A five-year-old fintech company ~~that has made three acquisitions~~ wants to build its ethics program on virtue ethics. ~~Its board meets quarterly and its compliance budget is fixed for the year.~~ Which program fits that approach best?

Target word: program that reflects virtue ethics **Decides:** Virtue ethics develops character through habit and example.

A	Correct	Virtue grows through role models and practiced habits.
B	Absolute language	No one has perfect character; virtue ethics stresses ongoing development.
C	Confusion set	A rules-and-penalties program is compliance, closer to duty-based ethics.
D	Adjacent category	Scoring outcomes is utilitarian.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A ~~90-person~~ engineering firm gave every employee the same \$3,000 year-end bonus. Employees agree the amounts were fair, but they are upset that the bonus rules were decided in secret, with no explanation and no way to ask questions. ~~The firm had its best revenue year ever.~~ What kind of justice concern is this?

Target word: type of justice **Decides:** The complaint is about the process, not the amounts.

A	Adjacent category	Interactional justice concerns respectful treatment; the core complaint is the secret process.
B	Correct	Fairness of how decisions are made, including transparency and voice.
C	Inverted operation	Employees accept the outcome; distributive justice is about outcomes.
D	Dropped element	Drops the process complaint; equal outcomes do not settle process fairness.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A staff accountant at a regional bank, ~~who passed the CPA exam on her first try,~~ is asked by her manager to backdate invoices. She refuses, explaining that the law and professional rules require accurate records and society depends on people following them. At which Kohlberg level is her reasoning?

Target word: level of reasoning **Decides:** Her reason rests on laws and rules that keep social order.

A	Dropped element	Judges the action and drops the reasoning, which is what Kohlberg scores.
B	Absolute language	Credentials do not set moral stage.
C	Correct	Reasoning from law, rules and social order is conventional (law-and-order).
D	Inverted operation	Preconventional reasoning is about punishment or self-interest; she did not mention either.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Which reason for refusing to falsify a safety report reflects Kohlberg's postconventional level?

Target word: postconventional reasoning **Decides:** Universal principles above the law or group.

A	Adjacent category	Rules and laws are conventional reasoning.
B	Confusion set	Self-interest is preconventional.
C	Inverted operation	Fear of punishment is preconventional.
D	Correct	Appeals to a universal principle beyond law.

9. Answer A Concept 6

At an investor conference, the CEO of a chemical company ~~with plants in six countries~~ says the firm's only social responsibility is to increase profits while staying within the law and fair competition. ~~The company's stock rose 12% last year.~~ Which view is the CEO expressing?

Target word: which view **Decides:** Profit within the rules is the only responsibility.

A	Correct	Friedman argued that business's social responsibility is to increase profits within the rules of the game.
B	Adjacent category	The pyramid adds ethical and philanthropic duties beyond profit and law.
C	Inverted operation	Stakeholder theory balances many groups, not only owners.
D	Confusion set	Triple bottom line measures people and planet as well as profit.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A manager using stakeholder theory is weighing whether to close a plant. What does she do?

Target word: stakeholder approach **Decides:** Balance the interests of all affected groups.

A	Inverted operation	That is the shareholder view.
B	Absolute language	Balancing interests does not give each group a veto.
C	Correct	Stakeholder theory balances all groups affected.
D	Dropped element	Drops the other affected groups.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A hospital administrator in a rural county must cut costs. She can either lay off a loyal 25-year employee or close a small outpatient clinic that serves elderly patients. ~~The hospital recently installed new imaging equipment.~~ What kind of ethical situation is this?

Target word: type of ethical situation **Decides:** Both options protect a real value: loyalty and community care.

A	Confusion set	Neither choice is clearly wrong.
B	Dropped element	Drops the human effects that make it an ethical choice.
C	Correct	Loyalty to the employee and care for the community are both right values in conflict.
D	Adjacent category	No law is broken either way; the conflict is between values.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A procurement manager at a ~~20-year-old family-friendly~~ manufacturer is reviewing three bids for a packaging contract. One bidder is owned by her brother-in-law. His bid is the lowest and his quality ratings are the best. What should she do?

Target word: correct handling of the conflict **Decides:** A family tie to a bidder is a conflict of interest.

A	Camouflage	Answers the bid details; the conflict exists regardless of the bid.
B	Inverted operation	Disclosure must come before the decision.
C	Absolute language	Relatives can bid; the conflicted person must step aside.
D	Correct	Disclosure and recusal protect the process whatever the outcome.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Utilitarianism	Judge an action by its consequences: choose the option with the greatest net good for everyone affected.	Calling any reasoning about outcomes “self-interest.”	Counting who is helped and harmed, and choosing the larger total benefit.
2	Deontology (duty ethics)	Some acts are right or wrong in themselves, whatever the results; Kant asks whether the rule could apply to everyone and whether people are treated as ends.	Assuming a good outcome can justify lying or using people.	Refusing an act “whatever the outcome,” or asking if everyone could do it.
3	Virtue ethics	Ethics comes from character: habits such as honesty, courage and fairness, developed through practice and role models.	Treating a rulebook or a cost-benefit score as virtue ethics.	“What would a person of good character do?” or building habits.
4	Distributive vs. procedural justice	Distributive justice is about the fairness of outcomes; procedural justice is about the fairness of the process used to decide.	Assuming equal outcomes end fairness complaints.	People accept the result but object to how it was decided, or the reverse.
5	Kohlberg's levels of moral reasoning	Preconventional reasons from punishment and self-interest; conventional from rules, laws and others' expectations; postconventional from universal principles.	Scoring the action rather than the reasoning behind it.	The “because” the person gives.
6	Shareholder vs. stakeholder view	The shareholder view (Friedman) says a firm's responsibility is to maximize profit within the law; stakeholder theory says managers must balance all groups affected.	Assuming stakeholder theory means every group gets a veto.	A statement about whose interests the firm must serve.
7	Right-vs-right dilemmas	A true ethical dilemma pits two right values against each other; a moral temptation is right versus wrong.	Calling any hard choice a temptation, or any costly choice “just business.”	Both options serve a real value such as loyalty, justice or community.
8	Conflicts of interest	When personal interests could influence a decision, disclose the conflict and step away from the decision before it is made.	Believing a good outcome or the best bid removes the conflict.	A relative, friend or personal stake connected to a business decision.

Course scope (public description): This course examines the ethical issues and dilemmas managers face. This course provides a framework for analysis of management-related ethical issues and decision-making action required for satisfactory resolution of these issues.